



Aircraft



The fastest way to travel is by air. Aircraft can carry people around the world in just a few hours.

Passenger plane

Planes today are often used to carry passengers long distances.

This one can carry more than 100 people.



Flying instruments

Cockpit

The cockpit contains the computers and controls used by the pilot.

Types of aircraft



Helicopters have spinning blades called rotors.



Hot-air balloons fly because hot air is lighter than cold air.

The fuselage is the body of the plane, where passengers sit.

Streamlined shape

Cockpit

Light aluminum body

Jet engines power the plane forward.

Wing flaps help the plane slow down and turn in the air.

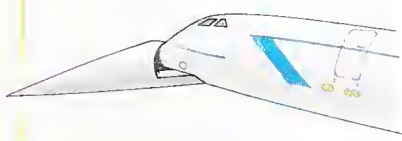
Wheels

These fold up inside the plane during flight.



Did you know?

The long, pointed nose of the Concorde "droops" so that the pilot has a clear view for landing!



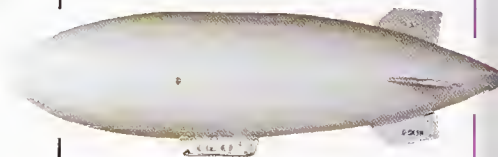
Black box

This records all the details of an aircraft's flight.

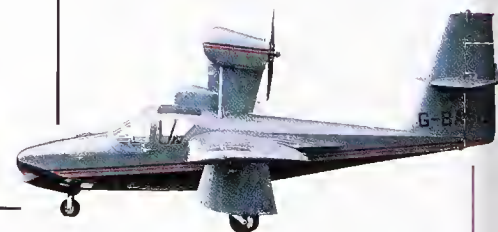


Escape chute

Air-filled chutes are the emergency exits from an airplane.



Airships are filled with helium gas, which is lighter than air.



Seaplanes have pontoons. They can land on water.

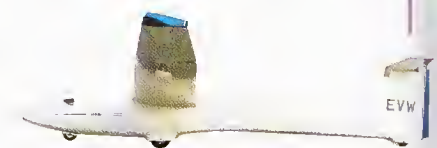
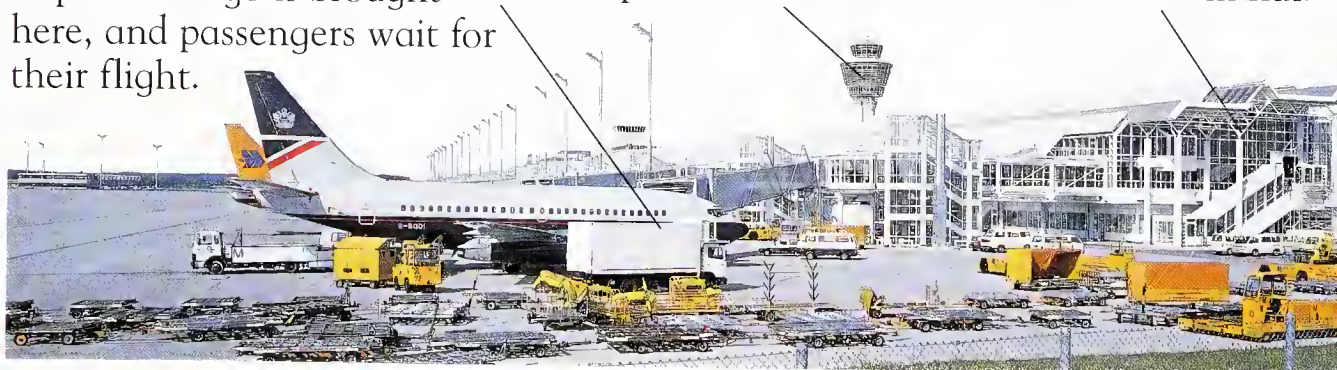
Airport

Planes take off and land at airports. Cargo is brought here, and passengers wait for their flight.

Food and drink is loaded onto a plane.

Staff direct takeoff and landing from the control tower.

Passengers wait in the terminal.



Gliders are towed up into the sky. They have no engine and glide on air currents.

